

Holy — wholly other

Sunday school · September 27, 2026 · Week 3 · Leader guide

Readers needed: John 1:12–13 · Isaiah 6:1–2 · 2 Chronicles 26:16–21 · Exodus 19:16–25 · Isaiah 6:1–4 · Isaiah 6:5 · Isaiah 6:6–8 · Luke 5:8 · Revelation 1:17 · Hebrews 12:18–24, 28–29

Teacher reads: Exodus 3:5

Memory verse: Isaiah 6:3 (same verse Wednesday). **Materials:** glory definitions handout, tickets, student handouts. **Punchline:** Undone by him. Welcomed by him. Both, every Sunday. **Launch question:** Which half are you missing? Undone, welcomed, both? Not answered from the front; Q1 lands it in breakout.

9:15 · Welcome — 3 min

- Icebreaker: favorite dinner, or one food you'd eat for a month straight. New people say their name first.
- Mission statement from the wall. Assign readers as students arrive.
- *Last week's verse one more time, then a new one.*

9:18 · Memory verse — 6 min · READER · John 1:12–13 READER · Isaiah 6:1–2

- READER, John 1:12–13 for context, then verse 14 together off the screen (full text). Next slide: first three words only. Anyone who recites it alone earns 3 tickets; tally on the board.
- Glory definitions handout goes out (theirs to keep). Chart slide: which bar John 1:14 is: God's own presence and worth, seen. God's own presence and worth slide: Exodus 34:6–7 on screen, no reader (read last week). Moses asked to see the glory and what passed by was a name and a character. That is the top bar defined; his glory is who he is, shown. If asked why other Bibles say wealth or honor: NIV translates by sense, NASB and ESV keep "glory," KJV varies (honour, praise, even "worship" in Luke 14:10). One word, five senses. And Moses can't see the face and live, which is today's question. One minute for both.
- Tickets: what earns them, what they buy.
- READER, Isaiah 6:1–2 for context, then 6:3 together off the screen, twice. It has both words, holy and glory. LORD in small caps is the name YHWH.
- *Last week was glory. This week is the other word in that verse.*

9:24 · Recall and definition — 2 min

- GLORY = _____. They fill it: weight. Click to reveal.
- Collect their definitions of "holy" on the board. Write everything, correct nothing.
- *Before Scripture defines it, one man who got it wrong.*

9:26 · Uzziah — 2 min · READER · 2 Chronicles 26:16–21

- READER. Fifty-two years a good king. Walks into the temple to burn incense that was never his to offer, and the priests say it: not for you, but for the priests (v. 18). Leaves a leper, cut off from the house of the LORD until he dies.
- Hold the name; it comes back at Isaiah 6:1.
- *Why did one act of worship cost him that much? Because of what holy actually means.*

9:28 · Qadosh — 2 min

- Hebrew qadosh, Greek hagios: set apart, other. Their board words (pure, sinless) are true but second. Before holy means good, it means a different category of being.
- Author and character: the biggest character in the book is still a character; the author isn't in the book at all, and every page depends on him. Flatland if it helps: a square can't picture a sphere, and when it passes through all he sees is a circle growing and shrinking.
- Teacher reads Exodus 3:5. Holiness isn't a property of the dirt. The ground is ordinary; it's holy because of who is standing on it. Things are holy by relation to him, never in themselves. Same with the temple, the vessels, the priests.
- *If he is that different from us, coming near him can't be on our terms. Sinai shows what it takes.*

9:30 · What "being other" demands — 3 min · READER · Exodus 19:16–25

- READER. Three demands, straight off the passage: consecration, even the priests (v. 22); a line around the mountain, death for crossing it (v. 21, 23–24); a mediator, Moses alone goes up and everyone else stays down (v. 20, 24).
- Trembling is their reaction, not what God asked for. You don't walk up to this; someone goes up for you.
- Uzziah broke the third one.
- *Israel stood outside the line. Isaiah gets taken inside it.*

9:33 · Isaiah 6 — 3 min · READER · Isaiah 6:1–4 READER · Isaiah 6:5 READER · Isaiah 6:6–8

- READER, Isaiah 6:1–4. "In the year King Uzziah died." The king who barged in is dead; Isaiah is shown what was actually in there. Smoke, doorposts shaking at a voice: Sinai again. Nobody consecrated Isaiah; there's no line; he's standing inside everything Exodus 19 fenced off.
- READER, Isaiah 6:5. His first words are about himself, and specific: unclean lips, in a room where the seraphim's lips are saying holy. *Nidmêti*: undone, silenced, ruined. This is the right response to holy: not a failure of worship, the first movement of it. Ask: how would you respond in there?
- READER, Isaiah 6:6–8. At Sinai the mediator goes up; here the coal comes down. Isaiah doesn't climb to it. It touches the exact place he named. Cleansed, then sent. Everything Sinai demanded, God supplies from his side.
- *Step back and look at the shape of the whole chapter.*

9:36 · What just happened to Isaiah — 1 min

- Four clicks: SEE (6:1–4), UNDONE (6:5), CLEANSED (6:6–7), SENT (6:8).
- That is what worship is, and it is the order of our own service every Sunday: we see him, we confess, we hear the pardon, we hear the Word and are sent. The middle beat is the one this room skips. No cleansed and sent without undone.
- *Isaiah isn't a one-off. Everyone who saw him responded the same way, before Jesus and after.*

9:37 · Everyone who saw him — 1 min · READER · Luke 5:8 READER · Revelation 1:17

- READERS. Peter, "depart from me." John, who leaned on Jesus' chest, falls as though dead. They knew him best and both came apart when they saw him.
- The Old Testament rows stay on the screen, one sentence for all of them: treat the holy as common and it kills you.
- *Grace didn't make him less holy. Hebrews says it directly.*

9:38 · Conclusion — 2 min · READER · Hebrews 12:18–24, 28–29

- READER, 12:18–24, then 28–29. Sinai and Zion side by side: not the mountain that could be touched, but Jesus, the mediator of a new covenant. The mediator Israel needed is the one we have. Consecration, the way in, the one who goes up: all three met from God's side.
- Verses 28–29: reverence and awe, still a consuming fire. Grace did not lower the temperature.
- Punchline, both halves: undone (Isaiah, Peter, John) and welcomed (Hebrews 12, Mount Zion). Then the launch question; let it hang, don't answer it. Send them to breakout on it; Q1 lands the answer.
- If behind: cut Everyone who saw him first. Never cut prayer.

9:40 · Prayer wall — 15 min · 9:55 · Breakout — 15 min · Done 10:10

- Prayer wall: everyone writes, the heaviest thing. Breakout: student handouts; leader notes on the next page.

Breakout — questions and leader notes

The lesson lands on Q1. Two ways this room gets it wrong: welcomed with no undone (casual, me-centered, Uzziah), or undone with no welcome (anxious, or the right form with a dead heart, Isaiah 29:13). The fix for both is looking at him, never feeling enough. Extra encounters if needed: Leviticus 10:1–3, 2 Samuel 6:6–7, Acts 5:1–11; John 12:41 says the throne room is Christ.

High school

1. Undone and welcomed.

Isaiah saw God and fell apart; then the coal came to him and he was sent. Hebrews 12 says we haven't come to a mountain that can't be touched; we've come to Mount Zion, to the angels and the saints.

a. On a normal Sunday, which do you feel more: undone by him, or welcomed by him? Or neither?

b. What would it take to feel both?

- This is the question the whole lesson lands on. Both halves are the right response, and each one without the other goes wrong: undone with no welcome is anxiety or dead formality; welcome with no undone is casual, me-centered worship that forgets he's holy, holy, holy. Most of this room will say welcomed, or neither.
- For (b) don't let them try to manufacture a feeling. You can't force either one; you can only look. Behold him in worship, learn him in study, seek him in prayer, and let both grow on their own. Isaiah didn't work anything up; he saw.
- If someone says neither, that's honest and useful. Ask what they were looking at instead.

2. Zoning out.

a. How easy or common is it for you to be in church, zone out, and feel nothing?

b. What do you think is causing that?

c. What could help?

- Let them be honest first; it's common. Then push on the cause. Tired, phone, the same songs, the rest of the day. Underneath all of them: not actually looking at him.
- "What could help" comes from them, and it's about looking, not trying harder to feel. Concretely: the first verse on the screen, the words of the confession, watching for him in the sermon. Feeling nothing some Sundays is normal, not lost.

3. Reverence AND boldness.

a. Does your pattern of worship at 10:30 on Sunday mornings match this calling?

b. How do we do as a congregation at coming with reverence and boldness?

c. How could we improve, individually and as a church?

- Get concrete on the individual side first: the first two minutes, what they do when a song they don't like starts, what they do during the confession.
- Reverence and boldness hold together because both come from being given something you didn't earn (Hebrews 10:19–22 with 12:28–29). Election is the ground for the boldness; the trembling is because it's him.
- On the congregation: keep it honest and unsnarky. Isaiah 6 is the order of our service on purpose; ask whether we treat each part like it matters. Improvement should be one thing they'd do, not a critique of the adults.

Jr high

1. Uzziah was a good king who did one thing he wasn't allowed to do. Why do you think God treated it so seriously?

- Holy means God sets the terms, not the worshiper. Uzziah decided for himself what he could do in God's house. Same with Nadab and Uzzah.
- Steer away from "God is harsh." God's house isn't ours. Ask: whose rules do you follow at a friend's house?

2. Zoning out.

a. How often are you in church and just zoned out, feeling nothing?

b. What do you think is going on when that happens?

- Let them be honest; it's common. Don't rush to fix it.
- Let them be honest; it's common. Underneath tired, bored, and phone: not actually looking at him. The fix is looking, not trying to feel. Isaiah wasn't trying to feel anything; he saw.

3. What's one thing you could do differently before church starts on Sunday, knowing who you're about to meet?

- Concrete and small: how they walk in, what they do while waiting, whether they read the first verse on the screen.
- Not a rule list. One thing, their choice, for this week.